

# PERSONAL INITIATIVE

Self-Starting



Training

## WHAT YOU NEED TO DO Self-Starting

- ① Don't react to what's happening around you. Act first to outperform your competitors!
- ① DON'T copy competitors, you must offer something different.
- ① If your circumstances are challenging, actively work to change them .
- ① Think before you act - random actions are useless.
- ① **But:** Be quick – you've got to collect feedback before implementing actions
- ① It is **actions** that turn ideas into reality - get up and do it!



# REACTIVE AND PROACTIVE BEHAVIOUR



LAID BACK



GET UP AND DO IT!

- Imitate/copy exactly what competitors are doing
- Complaining about things and hoping they will get better
- Waiting for people to give you information
- Rely only on what you already know
- Waiting for ideas to show themselves
- Wait for the right circumstances to realise your ideas
- Sticking to old habits



FAILURE

- Being different - doing something new  
Learn from others, but be different
- Changing difficult circumstances
- Actively seeking information
- Actively seeking new ideas
- Seeking opportunities to learn
- Realise your ideas now
- Trying new methods



SUCCESS!



# Changing Difficult Circumstances

- When situations are difficult change them!
- With life threatening danger mounting for her people (and also herself), Esther bravely stepped forward to change the circumstances

Esther 4: 12-15



# JUMP OUT OF YOUR COMFORT ZONE!



SELF-STARTING



YOUR  
REGULAR  
WORK

Look for new ideas and opportunities!



Be different!



Offer new products/services!



Learn new things!



Introduce a new way of  
making/selling/offering!



Set a goal and plan!



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# EXERCISE



This exercise presents two case studies of women entrepreneurs in Kenya

The first female entrepreneur shows Get Up & Go! behaviour while the second female entrepreneur shows Laid Back behaviour.

Form groups of **Four (04) people** to work on this exercise.

## Groups A:

- Look at **case 1 « Get Up & Go female entrepreneur"**.
- Identify and record what is proactive in their behaviour and the consequences of this.

## Groups B :

- Then look at **case 2 « Laid Back female entrepreneur"**.
- Identify and note what is reactive in their behaviour and the consequences of this.





# GET UP & GO! ENTREPRENEUR: ANNIE

Hello, I am Annie. I produce and sell herbs from my region. Before that, I worked in a food laboratory for four years. To learn how to run a business, I regularly watch videos on the internet about accounting and management. My business has grown steadily over the past few years. I recently set myself the goal of doubling my turnover within a year. To get higher prices for my products, I tried to contact a supermarket in Nairobi. As no one responded to me, I asked a friend, who works for the supermarket, to take a sample of my products to his manager. In this way, I was able to attract the attention of the management and began collaborating with the supermarket.

To deliver my products to the supermarket, I work with a local farmer, who often travels to Nairobi. I'm also working to ensure my products are certified 'organic', because I believe organic products will be in greater demand in the coming years and I will be able to get a better price for them.

WHAT IS ANNIE'S ACTIVE BEHAVIOUR?

WHAT ARE THE CONSEQUENCES OF THIS BEHAVIOUR?



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# *LAID BACK* ENTREPRENEUR: PAULINE

Hello, my name is Pauline. I learned about the production and marketing of herbs from my parents. When they got older, I took over their business and basically stuck to their business routine because it worked okay for them. I never really looked for new ways to do anything, like increase production or improve marketing.

However, one of my main problems is packaging and selling my herbs. It takes a long time to get into Nairobi to buy the packaging I need. As a result, I avoid travelling if possible, but that means I can run out of boxes and bags for my products. For the same reason, I don't usually attend the big trade markets where my competitors exhibit their products and look for business partners. Slower sales also mean I lack space to store my products. I can't really think of anything I can do to change these problems; I'm just hoping one day there will be a new road to Nairobi.

WHAT IS PAULINE'S REACTIVE  
BEHAVIOUR?

WHAT ARE THE CONSEQUENCES OF THIS  
BEHAVIOUR?



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# EXERCISE Self-Starting

Example: Daily routine of a small grocery shop owner

| Time   | Activities                                                                                                                                                                              |
|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8.00   | Open the shop and put up the usual advertising outside the shop.                                                                                                                        |
| - 8.45 | Wait for the first customer.                                                                                                                                                            |
| 9.00   | Telephone call from the supplier: he will not be able to deliver fresh fruit today. This is already the third time this has happened in a fortnight. Hopefully it will get better soon. |
| 9.30   | Customer service. Some people leave the shop without buying anything because they are only looking for fresh fruit. Send these customers to the competitor on the next street.          |
| 11.00  | Not many customers today, use the time to call friends and start chatting.                                                                                                              |
|        | Cleaning of the shop front and signage.                                                                                                                                                 |
| 1.00   | Closing of the shop.                                                                                                                                                                    |
| 4.30   | Counting sales and calculating turnover for today - a bad day...                                                                                                                        |
|        | Instruction:                                                                                                                                                                            |

Review this shop owner's routine and identify where they should be more Go-Getting!



# EXERCISE Self-Starting



Instruction:

Work in groups of ~Two (02) people.

1. Each write down activities from your most recent working day
  - What went wrong?
  - Where have you been Active? Where have you been Laid Back?
  - What more active behaviours could you have used instead?
2. Share with your partner



# WHAT YOU NEED TO DO

## Being Future-Oriented



Think about future opportunities in the market and make notes on how you can use them for your business.

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Think about the barriers that might arise in the future and prepare for them now.

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Always anticipate long-term consequences before acting on future opportunities and barriers.